

Catherine Azelby

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Education

Northeastern University	Sept 2022 - Dec 2026
<i>Candidate for a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Media Arts (Animation)</i>	GPA: 3.730, Dean's List

Technical Skills

Animation	Maya, Unreal Engine, Blender, Houdini Solaris, Adobe Substance Painter, XGen, Marvelous Designer
Programming & Tech	Python, OpenUSD, MaterialX, Unity, C#, UE Blueprints, MEL, Git, AWS, HTML, CSS, Javascript
Art & Other	Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe After Effects, Adobe Premiere Pro, Jira, Confluence, MS Office

Work Experience

Lucasfilm Industrial Light & Magic (ILM)	Jun 2026 - Aug 2026
<i>Advanced Development Group: Virtual Production Content Pipeline Intern</i>	San Francisco, CA
- Developed a custom MaterialX node graph in Houdini Solaris to implement an ILM shading model to support previs and postvis workflows - Ran LookDev tests and documentation across various DCC renderers including Hydra/Storm, Karma, Unreal Engine, and Renderman - Created shader translation graphs to further assist previs workflows using glTF PBR with ILM shading models	

MIT Department of Mechanical Engineering: LEAP Group	Jan 2026 - May 2026
<i>Game Developer & Research Assistant</i>	Boston, MA
- Worked in Unity to expand a custom desktop authoring platform seamlessly linked to a student-facing learning application. Features included: - AWS S3 data persistence mechanics to securely handle user files and private image uploads. - Dynamic 3D measurement generator, context-aware isolation tools, and custom box-collider scaling handles. - Instructor portal featuring secure authentication, direct cloud publishing flows, and student access-key validation. - Created optimized, high-fidelity game assets 3D modeled in Blender and textured with Substance Painter.	

HyLite Studios	Jun 2025 - Oct 2025
<i>3D Visual Designer</i>	Remote
3D modeling and texturing platform-compliant assets in Blender for Meta Horizon Worlds. Ensuring optimization for real-time performance while maintaining visual appeal.	

Northeastern University	Jun 2025 - Oct 2025
<i>Comic Illustrator</i>	Remote
Managing all aspects of art and illustration for “Chloe and the Locked Library” utilizing Photoshop, including character design, paneling, and cover illustration, ensuring timely delivery and alignment with the writer’s vision.	

Northeastern University XR Ed Lab	Jan 2025 - Jun 2025
<i>Virtual Reality Developer & Research Assistant</i>	Boston, MA
- Designed the prototype for a virtual reality field trip with Unreal Engine 5 and Meta Quest Developer Platform. Created an interactive car-crash simulator meant to engage and teach high school students about the physics concept of impulse. - Collaborated with a local high school to conduct focus groups and interviews with teachers evaluating the effectiveness of VR learning experiences. Findings were synthesized and contributed to a paper submitted and accepted into the Meaningful XR Conference.	

Projects

EasyBlink: Maya Plugin: Python and MEL-based Maya plugin automating blink animation across character rigs.	
CameraLink: Maya/Unreal Plugin: Enables easy camera transfer between Autodesk Maya and Unreal Engine using industry-standard USD composition. Created with Python and C++.	

Leadership, Involvement, and Honors

ACM SIGGRAPH Vancouver 2025 Student Volunteer	Aug 2025
Assisted in providing conference support, guidance, and organization to guests attending the SIGGRAPH conference.	
24 Hour Animation Challenge Top 50 Finalist	Oct 2025
Worked with a team of 5 to create a 30-second animated film within 24 hours. The final film placed 29th out of over 700 teams.	
MIT Reality Hack: Best Lifestyle World with Meta Horizon Worlds	Jan 2025
3D artist and modeler and presentation material lead for the winning team of the Meta Horizon Worlds track at MIT Reality Hack 2025.	
Games, Art, and Play: Japan Study Abroad	July 2024
Study abroad focusing on game design applications and principles. Created a visual novel dress-up game in Python and Photoshop.	
Northeastern Animation Club President	April 2024 - April 2026
Oversees club events, outreach, and activities. Plans events such as speaker events, film festivals, and alumni networking.	
Northeastern College of Arts, Media, & Design Student Ambassador	Sep 2025 - April 2026
Assisting with undergraduate recruitment and marketing efforts through sharing personal experience and advice.	
Northeastern Animation Club Graphic Designer	April 2023 - April 2024
Creator of all club promotional materials, such as flyers and social media graphics, using Adobe Illustrator.	